

MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS

JANUARY 2026

For All India Competitive Examinations

SSC | UPSC | Railway | Banking | State PSC | Defence

SECTIONS COVERED:

1. National Affairs & Government Schemes
2. International Affairs
3. Defence & Security
4. Economy & Banking
5. Science & Technology
6. Sports
7. Awards & Honours
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DISCLAIMER: This compilation is based on publicly available information.
Verify all facts from official sources before relying on them for exams.

NATIONAL AFFAIRS & GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

Republic Day 2026

- > India celebrated its 77th Republic Day on January 26, 2026 with the theme '150 Years of Vande Mataram'.
- > The Beating Retreat ceremony was held on January 29, 2026 at Vijay Chowk, New Delhi.
- > India's first legged mobile manipulator 'Scorpio' displayed on Republic Day.
- > LR-ASHM (Long Range Anti-Ship Missile) displayed in Republic Day parade.

Government Initiatives

- > Cabinet approved continuation of Atal Pension Yojana for FY 2026-27.
- > Equity infusion for SIDBI approved to support MSME sector.
- > Launch of #SkilltheNation challenge by the Government.
- > Smart fishing harbor project approved by the Cabinet.
- > Grand International Exposition on Buddhist relics inaugurated - PM Modi visited.
- > 3rd Indian Lighthouse Festival held in Visakhapatnam.
- > First Vande Bharat Sleeper Train introduced.
- > Economic Survey 2025-26 presented on January 29, projecting GDP growth at 7.4% for FY26.
- > Budget Session of Parliament commenced on January 28, 2026.
- > MISHTI Scheme national workshop conducted in Vijayawada, AP (Mangrove conservation).
- > Surat, Gujarat set to become India's first slum-free city.
- > 'B for Business' visa launched for Chinese citizens (up to 6 months).
- > India to be the first country to use biocitumen for road construction.
- > Kalpetta district court (Kerala) became India's first paperless court.
- > Keifang declared India's first 'Bio-Pi' district.
- > Bengaluru ranked top city in India for women's safety.
- > 'Pankhudi' portal launched for women and children CSR partnerships.
- > UIDAI launched new mascot named 'Uday'.
- > EV manufacturing unit inaugurated by Defence Minister in Lucknow.
- > Railway electrification: India achieved 99.2% (as of Nov 2025).
- > Radhapani Tiger Reserve (MP) renamed after Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar. Total tiger reserves: 58.

Miscellaneous National

- > India surpassed China to become world's No.1 rice producer.
- > Indian Army's theme for 2026: 'Networking and Data-Centric Operations'.
- > Aralam Wildlife Sanctuary (Kerala) renamed as Aralam Butterfly Sanctuary.
- > Tiger Stripe butterfly declared official butterfly of Chandigarh.

- > New naval base planned at Haldia Port, West Bengal.
- > Nipah virus cases detected in West Bengal.
- > Rabies included under the Endemic Diseases Act.
- > Nagori Ashwagandha (Rajasthan) received GI Tag.
- > Delhi World Book Fair guest country: Qatar.
- > 72nd National Volleyball Tournament inaugurated in Varanasi, UP.
- > West Bengal CM inaugurated bridge to Sagar Island over Muri Ganga River.
- > 8th Pay Commission: Assam became first state to form committee.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

Key Developments

- > India to host BRICS 2026 Summit. Theme: 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation, and Sustainability'.
- > German Federal Chancellor Friedrich Merz visited India during International Kite Festival.
- > G7 meeting on Critical Minerals hosted by USA; India and Australia invited.
- > 52nd G7 Summit to take place in France. SCO Summit in Turkey. G20 Summit in USA.
- > 5 new non-permanent members joined UNSC: Bahrain, Colombia, Congo, Latvia, Liberia.
- > Ahmed Awad bin Mubarak appointed new PM of Yemen.
- > Israel withdrew from 7 UN agencies.
- > SpaceX launched 'Cosmo-SkyMed' satellite for Italy.
- > NASA's Artemis II mission scheduled for February 2026 (4 astronauts to Moon).
- > Major wildfire occurred in Argentina.
- > 28th Conference of Commonwealth Speakers hosted by India (headed by Om Birla).
- > US took action against Venezuela's former leader Nicolas Maduro.

DEFENCE & SECURITY

Military Exercises

- > Exercise Desert Cyclone-II: Joint military exercise between India and the UAE.
- > GULF SHIELD 2026: Hosted by Saudi Arabia (GCC nations exercise).
- > Exercise SAHAS SHAKTI: Indian Army exercise in Dhangi Hills (Gujarat/Maharashtra/Goa).
- > BRICS joint military drills conducted in January 2026.

Appointments & Developments

- > Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor appointed as Vice Chief of Air Staff.
- > CDS Anil Chauhan inaugurated new IAF base at Car Nicobar.
- > Shatrujeet Kapur appointed DG of Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP).
- > 'Bhairav' Drone Operations Command established for specialized drone warfare.
- > 'Suryastra' weapon system: Indian Army partnered with NIBE Limited.
- > DRDO developed 'SWADHES' portable water purifier.
- > Pakistani drone incursion spotted at LOC in J&K.
- > 25th anniversary of Tejas aircraft (4.5 gen fighter) celebrated by IAF.
- > China developed Type 052D guided-missile destroyer (in news).

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

ISRO

- > PSLV-C62 mission launched on January 12, 2026 from Sriharikota carrying 16 satellites.
- > Primary payload: DRDO's EOS-N1 (Anvesha) - strategic 'eye in the sky' satellite.
- > Mission FAILED due to anomaly in 3rd stage of launch vehicle.
- > Included India's first orbital AI-image laboratory and first on-orbit refuelling model.
- > Shukrayaan (Venus mission) announced as India's upcoming mission.
- > ISRO completed study on cosmic dust.

Other Developments

- > India's first AI Clinic inaugurated.
- > India's first bullet train project progress noted.
- > M-STrIPES app used for tiger census; initiated from Annamalai Tiger Reserve.
- > India's first solar-powered ATM van launched by Tripura Gramin Bank.
- > Kalai Hydro Power Project (12,000 MW) planned for Arunachal Pradesh.
- > Wangchu Hydro Power Project in Bhutan to be developed by Adani Group.
- > Green Ammonia plant established near Kakinada, Andhra Pradesh.
- > Galaxy Frog (endemic to Western Ghats, Kerala) in news.
- > 3D image of a volcano captured in Mexico.
- > 2000-year-old Kushan coin (King Vasudeva era) discovered.

SPORTS

Cricket

- > Virat Kohli completed 28,000 runs across all international formats (2nd after Sachin).
- > Rohit Sharma awarded Padma Shri.

Other Sports

- > 2nd Khelo India Beach Games 2026 held in Diu (Goghla Beach). Champion: Karnataka. Mascot: Pearl (dolphin).
- > SG Pipers won Women's Hockey India League 2025-26 (defeated Sorangi Bengal Tigers in Ranchi).
- > Pawan Kalyan (AP) became first Indian to receive Samurai martial art honor from Japan.
- > MS Dhoni named Goodwill Ambassador for Pune-Gearing 2026 cycling event.
- > Devinder Singh Garcha (Hockey gold medalist) passed away in Punjab.
- > India's Henley Passport Index rank: 80th. Top: Singapore.

AWARDS & HONOURS

Padma Awards 2026 (Announced on Republic Day, Jan 25)

- > Total 131 Padma Awards approved (5 Padma Vibhushan + 13 Padma Bhushan + 113 Padma Shri).
- > Padma Vibhushan: Dharmendra Singh Deol (posthumous, Art), V S Achuthanandan (posthumous, Public Affairs), N. Rajam (Music), Piyush Pandey (Literature), Uday Kotak (Trade & Industry).
- > Notable Padma Bhushan: Mammooty (Art), Alka Yagnik (Art), Vijay Amritraj (Sports).
- > Notable Padma Shri: Rohit Sharma (Sports), R Madhavan (Art), Harmanpreet Kaur (Sports).

Other

- > Taylor Prize awarded to American scientist Toby Kiers.
- > Telugu book 'Agnishalu' on President Murmu launched at Andhra University.

APPOINTMENTS

- > Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor - Vice Chief of Air Staff.
- > Justice Revati Mohite Dere - First woman Chief Justice of Meghalaya High Court.
- > Shatrujeet Kapur - DG of ITBP.
- > Akasa Air - 5th Indian airline to join IATA.
- > Sanjay Malhotra - headed first Payment Regulatory Board meeting (RBI).

OBITUARIES

- > Madhav Gadgil - Prominent environmentalist, passed away in Pune.
- > Devinder Singh Garcha - Hockey gold medalist, passed away in Punjab.

IMPORTANT DAYS IN JANUARY 2026

- > January 1 - Global Family Day
- > January 4 - World Braille Day
- > January 9 - NRI Day (Pravasi Bharatiya Divas) - biennial event
- > January 10 - World Hindi Day (first World Hindi Conference in Nagpur 1975)
- > January 12 - National Youth Day (Swami Vivekananda Jayanti)
- > January 13 - Lohri / 'Dhiyan Di Lohri' in Punjab
- > January 14/15 - Makar Sankranti / Pongal / Magh Bihu / Bihu (Assam)
- > January 15 - Indian Army Day
- > January 16 - National Skill Day / Lokpal Day
- > January 23 - Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Jayanti (Parakram Diwas)
- > January 24 - National Girl Child Day
- > January 25 - National Voters' Day / National Tourism Day
- > January 26 - Republic Day (77th)
- > January 30 - Martyrs' Day (Shaheed Diwas) / World Leprosy Day